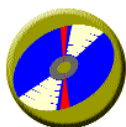


Off the Shelf



Will Rock

Serious Sam relived, with more graphics, more fun

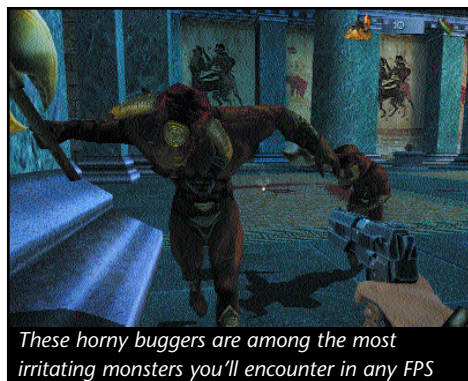
Over the years, games have evolved a lot, offering us a more mature experience in terms of features, weapons, save systems, and what not. Yet, once in a while, it's fun when scores of dumb but deadly monsters zero in on you.

The *Serious Sam* series is considered to be the pinnacle of this style. You had hundreds of nasties rushing at you from all possible directions. *Will Rock (WR)* draws inspiration from this seminal game, and brings back the same experience, complete with the look and feel of the original. In certain stages, it even surpasses its grand daddy.

It's got the look!

WR closely emulates *Serious Sam*. While gameplay is still more or less the same, the graphics have been touched up to look even better. On closer inspection, it seems that Saber Interactive apparently worshipped *Croteam's* smash hit and decided to clone it literally.

The premise of such a game is to pit one man carrying 10 weapons against hundreds of monsters, all pouncing on him at the same time. What matter here are your reflexes and hand-to-eye co-ordination. Puzzle-solving and strategising come a distant second.



These horny buggers are among the most irritating monsters you'll encounter in any FPS

What's the story, Morning Glory?

This is another area where *Saber* wastes more time. You're Willford Rockwell, studying archaeology purely to get close to his girlfriend, Emma, whose father happens to be a full-blown professor. A research trip to Mt Olympus in Greece leads to the discovery of the city of the Gods. A bunch of crazy terrorists want to resurrect the Greek Gods and kidnap Emma to offer her to Zeus as a bride. The professor gets slain while rescuing his daughter, and you accidentally set the Titan *Prometheus* free, who infuses you with his power in your quest for revenge.

Now compare this with *Serious Sam*, which had the best story that a game of its kind should have. It didn't trouble you by forcing something you weren't interested in anyway. Most of the players would merely ignore this and go on with the game. *Serious Sam* had no story to speak of, and it was proud of that fact. It was classy, unlike *WR*, which tries to act 'evolved'.

WR emphasizes on puzzles and complex design. You have all those underground passages and tunnels you need to cross, when instead, you could have spent all that time fighting monsters out in the open. Then come the sick jumping puzzles, where you have to jump from one platform to another, with the odd critter merrily sniping away at you.

Finally, you have monsters that keep coming back from the dead, hurling axes at you. It might be interesting for a while, but each level keeps throwing more and more of these pests. *Saber* sadly opts for quantity rather than quality here.

The last level can, at best, be torturous. Games like these are not supposed to



The first boss enemy you encounter. There's plenty more where that came from

have levels that ask you to stop and think where the hell you currently are.

Despite all that, *WR* has its quota of fun. A nice touch is added by the unusual weapons, including one that pumps its victim with acid until it explodes, and a cross-bow with fire-tipped darts. Among the weapons, the minigun stands out. It's fun and user-friendly, spewing hundreds of pointed tipped bullets a minute.

The sound effects and background score are good enough to keep your foot tapping. The game starts off with the 80s classic *I Wanna Rock* by *Twisted Sisters*. It's fun to listen to, but soon gets monotonous.

Go for the Multiplayer...

One area where the game outclasses others is in its co-op multiplayer mode. It even beats *Serious Sam* hands down in this department. Compared to this experience, the single player campaign is downright dull by comparison, and a lot tougher.

If you're looking for a great game to enjoy with a bunch of friends, then your hunt is over. *Will Rock* will rock you, for sure!

From SKOAR! magazine

Genre: Action ■ **Developer:** Saber Interactive ■ **Publisher:** Ubisoft ■ **Distributor:** Sujata Softech ■ **System Requirements:** 500 MHz CPU, 128 MB RAM, GeForce2/ Radeon class card, 750 MB free space, DirectX 9.0 ■ **Price:** Rs 299 ■ **Web site:** www.will-rock.com

Rating: ★★★★★